DAILY DEBRIEF 8 (02/24/2026)

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Global equities rebound as AI-disruption fears ease after Anthropic's enterprise event and a blockbuster Meta–AMD compute deal, with US stocks led by software, semis and select cyclicals while banks and energy lag. Treasuries are mixed with curve flattening and a soft 2Y auction, the dollar firms on yen weakness, gold slips, silver rises, bitcoin steadies and crude pulls back. Confidence tops estimates as regional manufacturing softens, Fed speakers flag stalled inflation progress and AI labor uncertainty, and focus shifts to NVDA earnings, software results and the durability of hyperscaler AI capex.

Stocks

USA	Europe	APAC
S&P 500 +0.79%	DAX -0.02%	Hang Seng -1.82%
NASDAQ +1.04%	Euro Stoxx 50 +0.04%	Nikkei 225 +0.87%
Dow Jones +0.76%	FTSE 100 -0.04%	CSI 300 +1.01%

As of 4:03 PM ET

Commodities

Energy	Metals	Agriculture
WTI Crude +0.06%	Spot Gold -1.24%	Corn -0.28%
Brent Crude +0.01%	Spot Silver -1.09%	Coffee +2.68%
HH Nat Gas -1.84%		Cotton +0.64%

As of 4:03 PM ET

Financial Market Monitor

Market Overview

U.S. equities moved higher, finishing off best levels as a software and AI rebound offset lingering tariff and geopolitical uncertainty. Leadership came from software, semis and housing-related names, while banks, insurers and energy lagged. Treasuries were mixed with modest curve flattening and a soft 2Y auction; the dollar edged up on yen weakness, gold fell, silver rose, bitcoin steadied and WTI crude declined.

Equities

Strength centered on software and AI beneficiaries following a constructive read-through from Anthropic's enterprise event and a blockbuster Meta–AMD compute deal, helping ease peak-capex and disruption fears. Semis outperformed with focus on AMD's agreement and positioning ahead of Nvidia earnings. Home Depot's upside surprise lifted housing-linked retail, while airlines, chemicals, machinery and credit cards also advanced. Financials underperformed amid scrutiny around AI-driven fundraising risks and private credit exposure. Earnings and M&A headlines continued to drive elevated single-stock dispersion.

Macro & Rates

Data were mixed but leaned constructive. February consumer confidence topped expectations with improved labor-market perceptions, while Richmond Fed manufacturing and factory orders softened. Fed speakers flagged stalled inflation progress and uncertainty around AI's labor-market impact, reinforcing a cautious, data-dependent stance. The Treasury's 2Y auction tailed slightly with lighter foreign demand, and $70B in 5s follow. Trade policy uncertainty remains in focus ahead of the State of the Union.

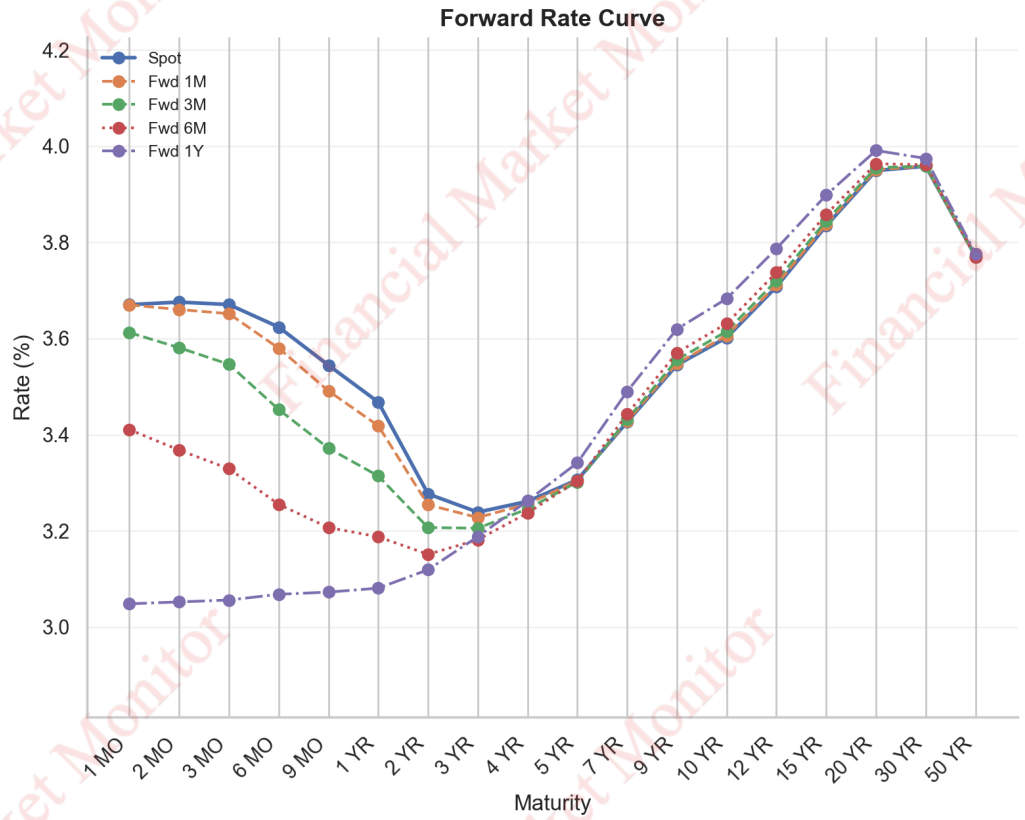
FX & Commodities

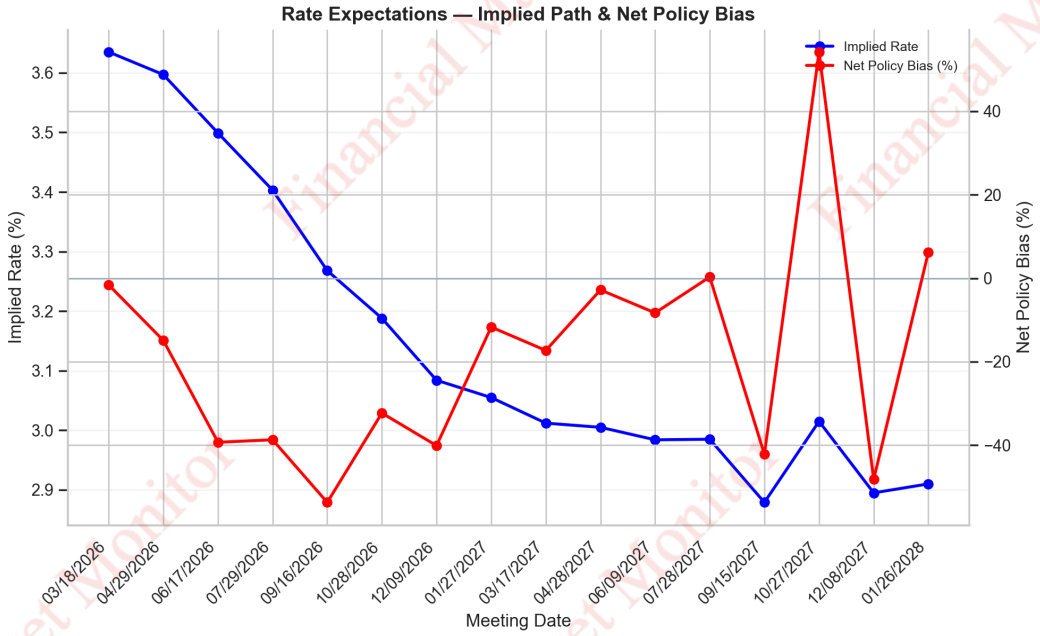
The dollar firmed modestly on yen weakness amid debate over further BoJ tightening. Gold declined while silver advanced, reflecting uneven haven demand. Bitcoin futures rebounded from intraday weakness, and crude pulled back despite ongoing U.S.-Iran tensions, as diplomatic momentum tempered immediate escalation risk.

Geopolitics

Attention remains on U.S.-Iran negotiations with limited strike risk still embedded in energy markets. Trade tensions persist following the Supreme Court tariff ruling and rollout of alternative measures, keeping policy uncertainty elevated even as equity markets refocus on AI capex visibility and upcoming earnings catalysts.

Financial Market Monitor





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